

Theories of Consumer Behavior

SPM381 Consumer Behavior in Sports

01

Definition of Sport Consumer Behavior

“The dynamic interaction of affect and cognition, behavior, and the environment by which human beings conduct the exchange aspects of their lives” (American Marketing Association, 2008).

- ♦ A textbook definition of consumer behavior is generally, “The study of individuals, groups, or organizations and the processes they use to select, secure, use, and dispose of products, services, experiences, or idea to satisfy needs and the impacts that these processes have on the consumer and society” (Hawkins, Best, & Coney, 2004, p. 7).

Definition of Sport Consumer Behavior cont.

— SIMPLE DEFINITION OF CONSUMER BEHAVIOR

“The study of why people buy.” (p. 51)

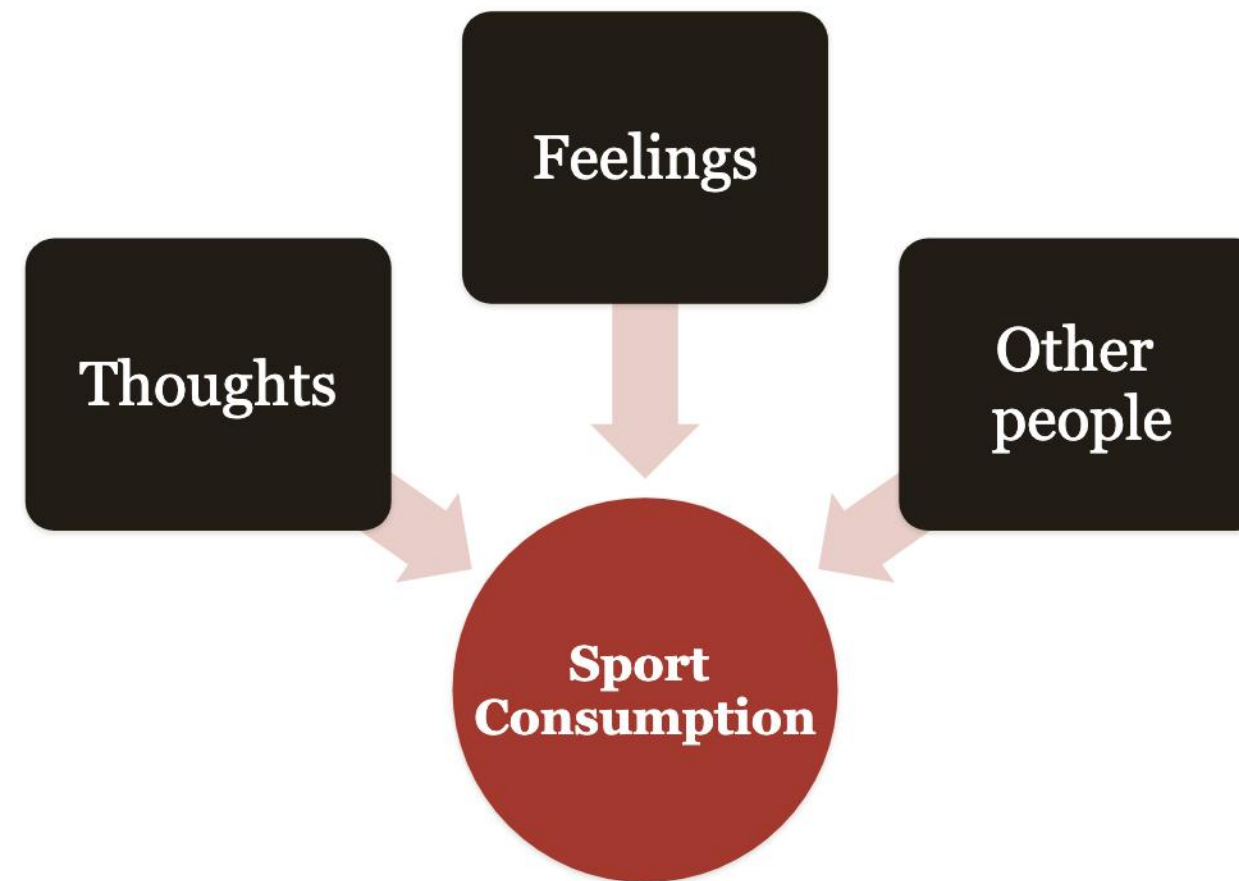
- ♦ Decision making process



Definition of Sport Consumer Behavior cont.

— FACTORS AFFECTING SPORT CONSUMPTION

- ♦ *Think about what other factors influence your sport consumption????*



Definition of Sport Consumer Behavior cont.

It is important for professional sport leagues and college athletic program to at least maintain a base of sport consumers, and in more cases than not, for organizations to work on increasing their levels of Attendance, Viewership, and Merchandise consumption.

Definition of Sport Consumer Behavior cont.

— WHO ARE SPORT CONSUMERS?

- ♦ <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mOHkRk00il8>
- ♦ Watch this clip!
- ♦ This was hilarious. → but a guy at 1:44 ☹



Who are sport consumers?

— STEWART ET AL. (2003) — THIS WEEK'S READING

- ❑ **Not all consumers are equally passionate.**
- ❑ **Neither are they all resistant to change (i.e., loyalty) that threatens team values and practices.**
- ❑ **Some attend games on a regular basis, while others attend only on special occasions.**



Challenges of narrowing a set of homogeneous traits.

Who are sport consumers? cont.

— DUALISTIC APPROACHES (BOYLE & HAYNES, 2000)

TRADITIONAL FANS

Traditional Fans

BOYLE & HAYNES (2000)

True supporters with a strong sense of the game's history and culture

MODERN FANS

Modern Fans

BOYLE & HAYNES (2000)

Attracted to the game because of entertaining



Who are sport consumers? cont.

— DUALISTIC APPROACHES (NASH, 2000)

CORE FANS

Core Fans

NASH (2000)

Grew up with the game · Built enduring emotional attachments to teams

CORPORATE FANS

Corporate Fans

NASH (2000)

Used the game to consolidate their social and professional network

Who are sport consumers? cont.

— DUALISTIC APPROACHES (FERRAND & PAGES, 1996)

IRRATIONAL FANS

Irrational Fans

FERRAND & PAGES (1996)

Emotional connections with a team

RATIONAL FANS

Rational Fans

FERRAND & PAGES (1996)

Inclined to use their club and team connection to secure a social or commercial benefits

Who are sport consumers? cont.

❖ Dualistic Fan Typologies

**Local teams to
construct a
sense of
community**

**Identifying
with a team**

Type 1 Fans

- Old
- Genuine
- Traditional
- Expressive
- Irrational
- Symbolic
- Die-hard

Type 2 Fans

- New
- Corporate
- Modern
- Submissive
- Rational
- Civic
- Less-loyal

Entertaining

**Identifying
with a city**

Who are sport consumers? cont.

— MULTIDIMENSIONAL TYPOLOGIES

- ♦ Multidimensional typologies reveal a multiplicity of social and psychological factors that shape the behavior of sport consumers.

Who are sport consumers? cont.

MULTIDIMENSIONAL TYPOLOGIES

Cluster type	Differentiating behaviors
Underlying motivations	Escape (to a less stressful 'sports-world') Eustress (excitement, and entertaining event) Social interaction
Emotional attachment	Obsessive attachment and strong commitment Moderate attachment and conditional commitment Slight attachment and fragile commitment
Economic attachment	High value: strong financial commitment Moderate value: intermediate financial commitment Low value: weak financial commitment
Identity	Team used to confirm self-concept Team used to confirm civic and community pride Team used to confirm social or cultural identity
Loyalty	Loyalty through game attendance Loyalty through displaying team colors Loyalty through chatter and conversation
Connective focus	Team is primary connection Sport or league is primary connection Player is primary connection
Overt experiences	Rational: strategic analysis Symbolic: gestures, ceremonies and rituals Social: play and social integration
Attendance at games	Frequent Moderate Low

Who are sport consumers? cont.

How?

- ♦ (1) Collection of information about the consumers that will allow for segmentation
- ♦ Commonly.....
- ♦ Gender, Age, Years of being a fan, Zip code, Frequency of ticket purchase, Income, etc.

Understanding of Sport Consumer Behavior

How?

- ♦ (2) Collection of information about psychographic variables that are better predictors of actual behavior.
- ♦ Customer Relationship Management (CRM)
- ♦ One file for each customer- the file includes information about all transactions and interactions a consumer has with the organization (e.g., ticket purchase).

Understanding of Sport Consumer Behavior cont.

How?

- ♦ (2) Collection of information about psychographic variables that are better predictors of actual behavior.
- ♦ *(1) What psychological variables do you need to include in your investigation?*
- ♦ (2) What tool (methods) do you like to adopt? Survey, Interview, phone interview? Etc.
- ♦ *(3) Sample? Target Population?*
- ♦ These are part of the questions for this week's discussion questions.

How to Study Consumer Behavior

“A variety of models and theories have been used to try and explain consumer behavior in general” (p. 60).

- ♦ *Model??*
- ♦ *Theory??*

How to Study Consumer Behavior cont.

— THEORIES

01 Identity Theory
p. 67

02 Social Identity Theory
p. 70

03 Attitude Theory
p. 72

04 Theory of Planned Behavior
p. 70

Source – To fully understand the concept of these theories, I strongly suggest reviewing the textbook. Textbook Trail, G. T (2018, 3rd edition). Sport Consumer Behavior. Seattle, WA. Chapter 2 Theories of Consumer Behavior p. 51. Identity theory– p.67. Social identity theory– p.70. Theory of Planned Behavior– p.70. Attitude Theory– p.72.

How to Study Consumer Behavior cont.

— THEORIES

Identity Theory

- ♦ Self is made up of interdependent and independent, mutually reinforcing and conflicting parts (Mead, 1934).
- ♦ People have as many identifies as distinct networks of relationship in which they occupy positions and play roles.

How to Study Consumer Behavior cont.

— THEORIES

Identity Theory

- ♦ Examples of your identities would be a student of Arcadia University, son or daughter of your parents, a fan of Eagles, etc.

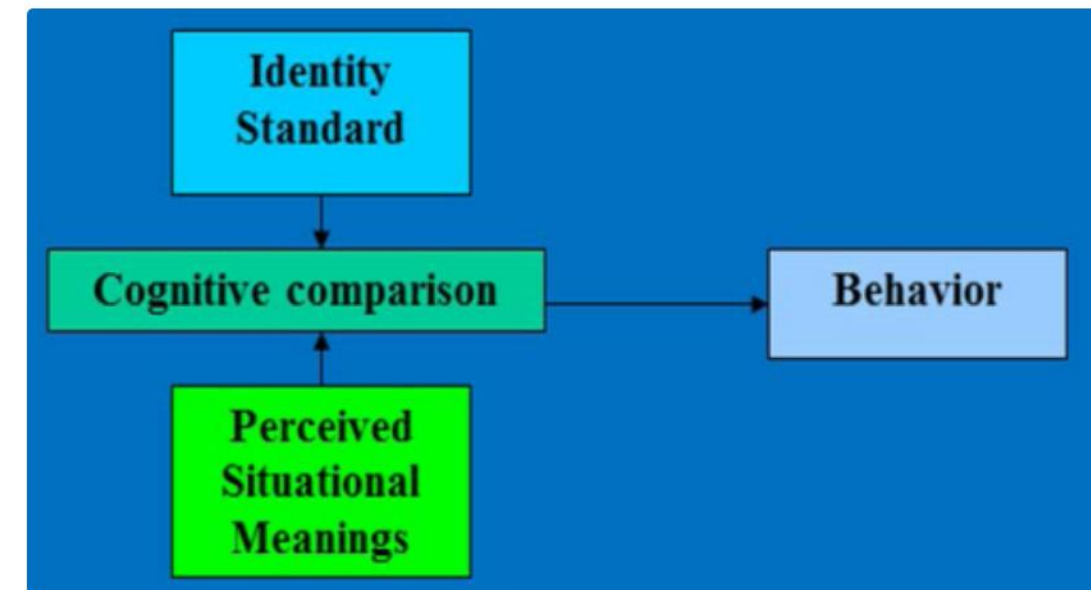


How to Study Consumer Behavior cont.

THEORIES

Identity Theory

- ♦ Identity standard – believing that a fan should act in a certain way.
- ♦ Drinking → you are not... disconnection → choose other social groups.



How to Study Consumer Behavior cont.

— THEORIES

Social Identity Theory

A social identity is a person's knowledge that he or she belongs to a group (Stets & Burke, 2000, p.225).

- ♦ Identification with a collectivity [category-based identities; Black or White, Christian or Muslim]

How to Study Consumer Behavior cont.

— THEORIES

Identity Theory vs. Social Identity Theory

- ♦ Both have been used to examine the identity of “fan.”
- ♦ Which theory is more appropriate to use? And Why? (p. 67-70, Trail 2018)
- ♦ This is part of this week’s discussion questions.

How to Study Consumer Behavior cont.

— THEORIES

Fans act differently because the identity standard is specific to the individual and varies to the extent that the individual wants it to vary relative to the perceived situational meanings.

How to Study Consumer Behavior cont.

— THEORIES

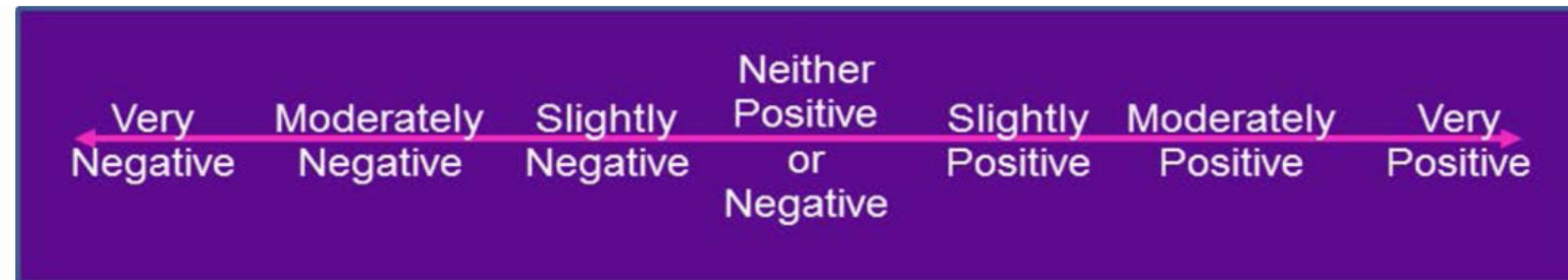
Attitude Theory

- ♦ Attitudes motivate behavior and they are comprised of both valence and intensity.
- ♦ Attitude can be defined as all classes of evaluative responding, cognitive, affective, or behavior.
- ♦ Valence of the attitude refers to the positive or negative evaluation of the entity.
- ♦ The intensity of attitude refers to the degree of the feeling.

How to Study Consumer Behavior cont.

— THEORIES

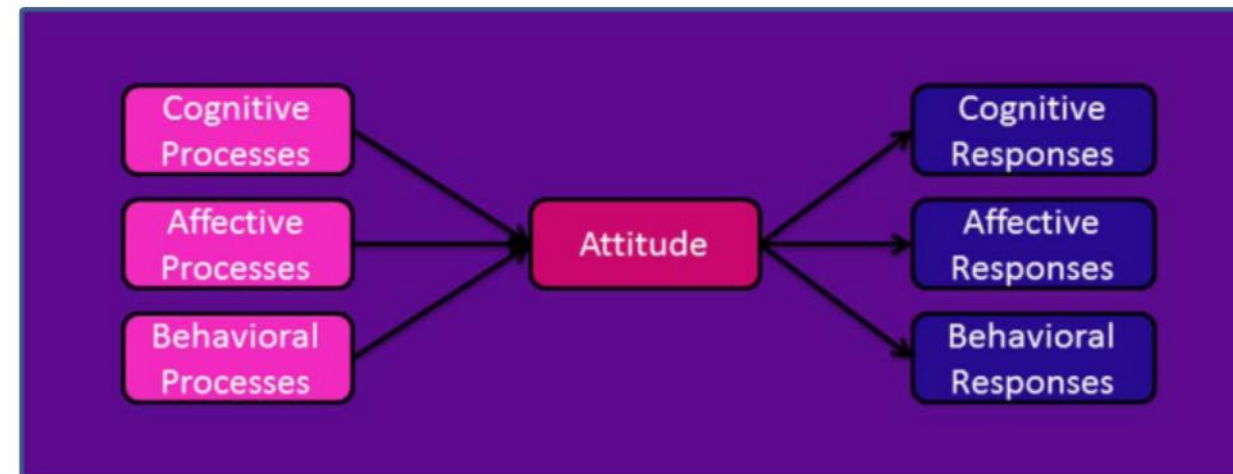
Attitude Theory



How to Study Consumer Behavior cont.

— THEORIES

Attitude Theory

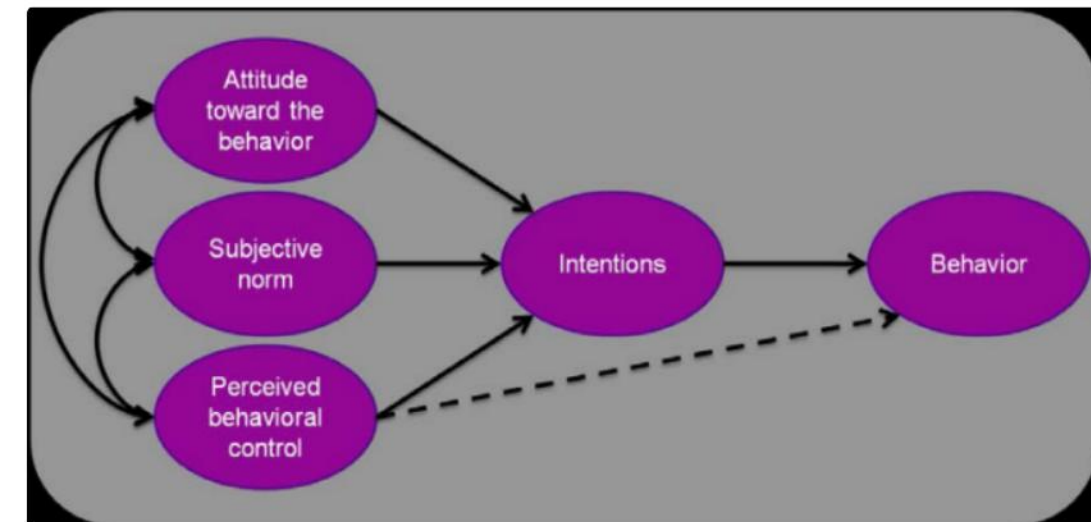


How to Study Consumer Behavior cont.

— THEORIES

Theory of Planned Behavior (Azjen, 1991)

- ♦ -Subjective norm: cultural thing, socially acceptable, perceived social pressure
- ♦ -Perceived behavioral control: perceived ease or difficulty of performing the behavior and its is assumed to reflect past experience as well as anticipated impediments and obstacles.



| Azjen (1991)

Questions???